

Mission Control Interview – Operational Protocols & Communication (Engineer)

Overview

This document captures firsthand insights into mission control operations, communication protocols, and decision-making practices from the perspective of an engineer. This information was gathered through an interview that we were able to conduct with **one** engineer. This information reflects lived experience, operational authority, trust structures, and real-time decision making during flight operations.

Conflict Resolution

Anticipating Issues

- As an engineer, you must expect that any conflict is possible during missions.
- As an engineer, there are certain things that you know are common issues throughout the day.

Critical Areas of Concern

- As an engineer, you are aware that some of the most pressing issues are the ones related to life support equipment.
- As an engineer, you need to put certain things “under a microscope” when they become a persistent problem.

Communication

Real-Time Communication

- Crew-11 team coming home early due to a medical emergency. They had to communicate and understand what was going on in real time.
- The flight team makes decisions in real time and they understand what they are doing.
- Taking that information and being able to communicate it from MCC to the rest of the ISS.

Long-Term Communication

- As an engineer, communication is based around a long-term scale.
- You must understand what the ISS long-term priorities are as an engineer.
- The communication process is well oriented as an engineer.

Requirements and Tracking

- You must set requirements and track them accordingly as an engineer.
- You have regular meetings with a planning team.
- You have a discipline called the OPS plan as an engineer.
- You must not bombard the flight control team with questions as an engineer.

Team Collaboration

- You work a lot with each flight control discipline as a team lead when you are an engineer.

Visibility In Mission Control Room

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Useful Tools

- Emergency contacts
- Procedures
- Checklist
- Console log

General Observations

- Almost every tool that you have by you is essentially useful as an engineer.